MycoWorks

Company Overview MycoWorks is a California-based biotechnology company that produces high-end leather alternatives from fungi. They have patented a unique process called "Fine Mycelium," which allows them to grow custom-engineered biomaterials that rival the quality, feel, and durability of traditional animal leather.

ESG Focus: Fine Mycelium Technology (Premium Bio-Leather)



Why (The Problem) Traditional cattle ranching for leather is a massive driver of deforestation, greenhouse gas emissions, and water consumption. On the flip side, most

synthetic "vegan leathers" are made from plastic (like polyurethane), which creates microplastic pollution and takes centuries to decompose.

How (The Solution) MycoWorks uses the root structure of mushrooms, called mycelium. They grow these cells in trays inside a controlled environment, feeding them agricultural by-products like sawdust. Unlike other mushroom leathers that just press fungi together, MycoWorks guides the cells to entwine as they grow, creating a dense, naturally strong sheet of material.

What (The Outcome) This results in "Reishi™," a premium biomaterial that can be tanned and finished just like animal hide. It matches the strength and luxury feel of the finest cowhide or alligator skin but is grown in just a few weeks. It is entirely biodegradable and has a fraction of the carbon footprint of livestock farming.

Impact: The company has partnered with luxury fashion icons like Hermès to create sustainable, high-end products. By proving that sustainable materials can meet the highest standards of luxury, they are accelerating the fashion industry's transition away from animal and plastic resources.